

ARTEXHIBITION

An Insider's View

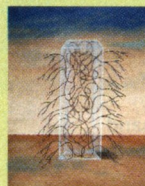
Eight women come together in a show titled *Intimate Lives*, to explore various issues. The show, curated by Anupa Mehta, portrays their diverse sensibilities.

◀ **Paula Sengupta, 42, Kolkata**

As a metaphor for pleasure and passion, Sengupta uses the tactile surface of hand-painted Indian chintz. Her drawings are rendered in a technique simulating Nakshi Kantha, a kind of quilting. The current collection is from her assemblage called 'His and Hers'.

▶ **Sarika Mehta, 29, Ahmedabad**

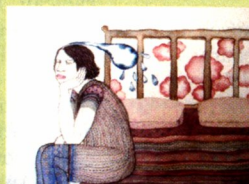
Mehta's artwork attempts to plumb the lowest depths of human potential and the farthest reaches of human emotions. She tries to "travel as deeply as possible, by cutting through the noise, to touch that virgin space that has the same effect on all humans". Her paintings depict a paradox of human existence.

◀ **Vidya Kamat, 44, Mumbai**

Kamat's works consist of loose strands of human hair hung on a wire string, shown to be dripping in blood. She attempts to make a cross reference to Mahabharata, where Draupadi is being sexually humiliated in public and unties her hair and challenges the Pandavas to tie it with Dushasana's blood.

▶ **Dhruvi Acharya, 38, Mumbai**

Acharya focuses on some of the facets of a woman's sexual life—fantasy, the preparation of her body when meeting her lover, seduction, separation and the heartbreak that follows. A middle-aged muse is used to show the emotions crossing the bounds of time.



At Mumbai's Tao Art Gallery from July 17 to 27.

by Swati Mathur

AUDIOBOOKS

Story BYTES

THE LIZARD'S TAIL
Rs 145



THE MONKEYS AND THE CAPSELLER
Rs 145

Gone are the days when parents would take their children to the library and narrate stories to them. Storytelling is a lost art and visiting libraries is also a thing of the past. To revive this, the popular Karadi Tales has launched an audiobook series and asked film stars to attract the young who are glued to the TV or computer. The latest books in the series are *The Lizard's Tail* and *The Monkeys and the Capseller*.

The storytellers The stories are narrated in English. Actor Vidya Balan narrates *The Lizard's Tail* written by Shubha

Viswanath. It's a story about a lizard who is looking for a new tail. The lovable Munnabhai, Sanjay Dutt, reads *The Monkeys and the Capseller*. His inimitable style is quite a change from his tough guy image. Both actors add personal anecdotes to make it come alive.

The aids They are dramatically told and musically supported by Three Brothers and A Violin. The title song by Shankar Ehsaan Loy is peppy. The CDs are enclosed in the books which are imaginatively illustrated by Malavika P. C. and Christine Kastl.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

FILM REVIEW



KAMBAKKHT ISHQ

Prattle of Sexes

RATING ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Sabbir Khan

Starring: Akshay Kumar, Kareena Kapoor

IF YOU HAVE 90 MINUTES, watch a Bharatanatyam performance in Kalakshetra style on July 21 by American Justin McCarthy, who performs, choreographs and teaches dance in India. At the India Habitat Centre, Delhi.